

KHO KHO SPARDHA'26 RULEBOOK

RULES:

1. Perfect Kho

To give a Perfect Kho, an Attacker shall touch the back of the Sitting Attacker with his hand from behind (palmar side of the hand) and utter the word "KHO" (simultaneously or immediately after touching), which must be heard by the Referee/Umpires and Defenders. Giving a Perfect Kho is the process by which an Attacker becomes a Sitting Attacker, and the Sitting Attacker becomes an Attacker.

2. To Take a Direction

When an Attacker moves from one Post Line to another Post Line, or after receiving a KHO, if he moves towards a particular Post Line, he is said to have taken a direction.

3. To Leave the Free Zone

When an Attacker loses contact with the Free Zone with his feet, he is said to have left the Free Zone. However, while attacking towards the Boundary Line, the Attacker must follow the Rules and Regulations regarding taking direction and receding.

4. To Reach the Free Zone

When an Attacker comes into contact with the Free Zone with his feet, he is said to have reached the Free Zone.

5. Out of Boundary / Out of Field

If a Defender loses contact of his body with the Playfield and goes into the Lobby, he is said to have gone Out of Field or Out of Boundary. However, if any part of the Defender's body remains in contact with the Playfield at all times while slipping/skidding or moving from the Playfield to the Lobby, it will not be considered Out of Boundary.

6. Entry

A Defender is said to have entered the Playfield as soon as he loses contact with the Lobby and comes into contact with the Playfield with his feet.

7. To Recede

When an Attacker, while moving in a particular direction, touches an area which he has already covered, it is considered as Receding.

The area covered is always measured with an imaginary line running along the Attacker's rear foot (parallel to the Cross Lane), in the direction opposite to the Attacker's movement.

8. Foul

If an Attacker or Sitting Attacker violates any Rule, it is known as a Foul.

Game Rules:

1. Referee shall call both the captains for the spin of the coin (Toss). He shall stand at the centre of the Playfield facing the Scoring Table/or towards the main stage, with both captains on either side. He shall instruct one of them to call the choice of the side of the coin. He shall then spin the coin and declare the winner of the toss. The coin shall be sufficiently heavy. The winner of the toss, after choosing Defence or Attack, cannot change his decision. In case of any dispute between the teams regarding the Home and Away Dugouts, the Referee may decide and allot them their respective Dugouts.
2. The winner of the toss shall raise his arm immediately and indicate, by his index finger, either the Central Lane (for Attack) or the Boundary Line (for Defence). No captain shall touch or pick up the coin before the Referee declares the winner of the toss. Doing so shall be considered unsportsmanlike behaviour, and the Referee shall declare the captain of the other side as the winner of the toss.
3. A **minimum of 09 players** is required to play a match. If a team is unable to field the requisite number of 09 players, it will not be allowed to play the match, and a walkover shall be given to the opponent team.
4. Any 8 Attackers shall occupy the Attacker Blocks facing the Boundary Line, such that no two adjacent Sitting Attackers face the same Boundary Line, and all Sitting Attackers sit such that their toes touch the line bifurcating the Attacker Block into two equal halves. The ninth Attacker shall stand in either Free Zone to start the Attack. Once the Free Zone is chosen to start the attack, it cannot be changed.
5. At the commencement of a turn, the first Batch of three Defenders shall be inside the Playfield, and the remaining Defenders shall occupy the seats meant for them. When a Defender is declared out, he shall occupy the seat meant for him in the Dugout.
6. After the commencement of a turn:
 - a) No Sitting Attacker shall stand unnecessarily in the Attacker Block during play. If he does so, the Referee shall give a verbal warning; repetition amounts to misbehaviour and may be penalised with a Blue Card (one-minute suspension).

The Attacker must be replaced immediately by a Substitute Player. The penalty is not carried forward to the next turn. If the Attacker does not wish to re-enter after the suspension, the Temporary Substitution converts to a Regular Substitution.

b) No Sitting Attacker shall interchange his Attacker Block with the adjacent Sitting Attacker. Doing so is unsportsmanlike behaviour, and the Referee may penalise both with a Blue Card. If either receives a KHO before replacement, a Foul (improper sitting) shall be given. If a Defender is touched by either of them before both are replaced, the Defender shall not be declared out.

7. During the match, if a team falls short of 09 players due to a Red Card or injury, that team shall not be allowed to play under any circumstances. If a Blue Card is given to an Attacker while the team has only 09 players (no substitute available), the turn shall be closed immediately without forfeiting the team's right to play its Defence turn.

8. An Attacker cannot cross the Central Lane between the Posts to reach the other half of the Playfield or the Free Zone.

9. Touching the Central Lane is not a Foul. However, if an Attacker crosses both lines of the Central Lane completely with his foot while attacking, it shall be considered a Foul. If the Attacker touches/crosses the Central Lane while touching, or just before or after touching a Defender, it is a Foul, and the Defender shall not be declared out.

10. When a KHO is given, an Attacker must touch the back of the Sitting Attacker with his hand from behind (palmar side) and utter the word "KHO" (simultaneously or immediately after touching), audible to the Referee/Umpires and Defenders. The Sitting Attacker cannot get up without receiving a KHO.

a) If the word KHO is uttered before the touch, it shall be deemed a Foul.

b) A single act of touching is not a Foul. If an Attacker touches the Sitting Attacker nearest the Post while a Defender is near the Post, a KHO must be given.

c) Uttering any word other than "KHO", or a word resembling it (even by a Sitting Attacker), is treated as a Foul.

d) Merely uttering "KHO" without touching by hand is also considered a Foul.

11. The following three actions of an Attacker giving a KHO are permitted, provided his feet do not go beyond the Cross Lane:

a) An Attacker's front foot need not necessarily touch the Cross Lane.

b) An Attacker may be positioned within the Cross Lane.

c) One foot of the Attacker must remain in contact with the Cross Lane at all times, while the rest of his body may extend beyond it.

12. After touching a Sitting Attacker (except the 8th, nearest to the Post), if the Attacker moves beyond the Cross Lane, he is deemed to have continued his attack and cannot utter KHO from a distance. However, if he moves along the Cross Lane toward the Boundary Line without committing a Foul, he may return and give KHO.

13. An Attacker cannot take support from a Sitting Attacker to put out a Defender, and a Sitting Attacker cannot physically help the Attacker avoid a Foul. If a Defender is touched under such circumstances, he shall not be declared out. Similarly, Defenders in the Entry Zone cannot physically assist the Active Defender to prevent him from going Out of Field; doing so results in the Active Defender being considered Out of Field.

14. An Attacker cannot give a KHO to an extended arm, leg, or any part of the body deliberately tilted towards him by a Sitting Attacker.

15. After receiving a KHO, the Sitting Attacker immediately becomes an Attacker and must move towards the half he is facing, taking the direction determined by crossing beyond the Cross Lane of his Attacker Block or by turning his shoulder line towards either Post.

16. After giving a PERFECT KHO, an Attacker ceases to be an Attacker and must sit down immediately on the Attacker Block of the Sitting Attacker to whom the KHO was given.

a) It is not a Foul if the Sitting Attacker, while sitting down, loses contact with the Cross Lane.

b) The natural time needed to sit down after giving a KHO must be allowed, provided it does not obstruct the Defender; if it does, a Foul shall be given.

c) After receiving a KHO, an Attacker cannot touch a Defender before leaving the Attacker Block.

17. During a Post Dive, if the supporting foot skids or slides back, it is not a Foul; however, touching or crossing the Central Lane with any part of the body or uniform is a Foul. The Attacker may swing his body in the air while diving but must land on the same side of the Playfield.

18. An Attacker cannot recede after taking a particular direction, except in the following cases:

a) While moving on the Cross Lane, if the Attacker steps back within the Cross Lane.

- b) If the Attacker steps back while getting up after a Flat Dive.
 - c) If the supporting foot skids/slides backward during a Post Dive.
 - d) If, after covering the Cross Lane at the start of an attack, one foot goes beyond the Cross Lane in the direction opposite to the attack.
19. An Attacker shall take a direction according to whichever of the actions mentioned in Rule 16 he performs first.
20. Once an Attacker has taken a direction, he must continue in that direction until reaching the Free Zone, unless he gives a KHO before that. He shall not move to the other half of the Playfield except by turning around the Post through the Free Zone.
21. The rules regarding taking direction and receding do not apply within the Free Zone.
22. Sitting Attackers must sit in a manner that does not obstruct Defenders. Deliberately moving or tilting the shoulder, thigh, or any other body part towards a Defender running near the Central Lane, so as to obstruct him, is treated as a Foul and warrants a warning. If the Defender is touched by the Attacker as a result of such obstruction, he shall not be declared out.
23. During a turn, an Attacker may go outside the Playfield, but he must follow all rules regarding taking direction and receding, even while outside the Playfield.
24. An Attacker shall not be compelled to enter the Playfield through the Free Zone if he has gone beyond the extended imaginary Post Line.
25. If an Attacker or Sitting Attacker violates any rule, the Referee/Umpire shall declare a Foul by blowing a short, continuous whistle and direct the Attacker to move in the direction opposite to the Active Defender. The Attacker must rectify the Foul either by giving a KHO or by continuing his attack in the opposite direction, as indicated. He may pursue other Defenders while rectifying but is not compelled to give a KHO.
26. An Attacker cannot change his direction simply by kicking the Post with his foot; doing so shall be declared a Foul.
27. A Defender cannot touch a Sitting Attacker to gain an undue advantage, and a Sitting Attacker must not be affected by a Defender's pulling, pushing, or dangerous touch, which is never permitted. A Defender who does so shall be warned verbally once; repetition in the same turn results in him being declared out.
28. A Defender shall be declared out by a short blow of the whistle if:

- a) An Attacker touches/tags him on any part of the body or uniform without violating any rule.
- b) He goes Out of Boundary / Out of Field.
- c) He has been given a verbal warning for touching the Sitting Attacker(s).
- d) A Red Card is shown to him.
- e) He commits a Late Entry.

29. If a Foul committed by an Attacker or Sitting Attacker gives no advantage whatsoever to the attacking side and no disadvantage to the Defender, the violation shall not be declared a Foul; it shall be ignored.

30. Deliberately pushing, catching, pulling (even by uniform), or hitting a Defender is treated as misbehaviour.

31. While attacking a Defender, if an Attacker violates a rule and pushes the Defender Out of the Field, the Defender shall not be declared out.

32. If a Defender is put out as a result of a Foul, or a Foul is committed immediately as a result of the action taken while putting him out, he shall not be declared out. ("As a result of action taken" implies no time lapse between the Foul and the action.)

General Match Rule:

1. The Captain/Coach shall submit a record of the T-Shirt numbers of the 06 Substitute Players to Scorer-2 at the beginning of the match.
2. Only in the 1st Inning, the Defending team shall intimate the position of all 09 Defenders in 03 Batches to Scorer-2 at the start of their Defence turn.
3. The Defending team sends its Defenders in 03 Batches, each Batch consisting of 03 Defenders.
4. A team may determine the order of its 03 Batches at the outset, but this order cannot change during that particular turn. Shuffling of Defenders between Batches is not allowed at any stage (except in a Minimum Chase).
5. At the start of a turn, 03 Defenders enter as a Batch. Subsequent Defenders enter only through the Entry Zone. When the last Defender of a Batch is declared out, the next 03 Defenders must be inside the Playfield before two PERFECT KHOs are given, failing which they are declared out for Late Entry.
6. Defenders who enter the Playfield early are not declared out, but are called back by the Referee/Scorer-2.

7. If the attacking team fails to tag/put out all 09 Defenders of the 03 Batches in the First Inning, the untagged/not-out Defender(s) get priority entry in the Second Inning, subject to the following:

a) If more than one Defender of a Batch remains Untagged/Not Out, they enter as the first Batch in the next Inning (which may or may not have 03 Defenders).

b) If only one Defender of a Batch remains Untagged/Not Out, he cannot continue in the next Inning; the next Batch enters as the first Batch instead.

c) If any Defender of the first or third Batch remains Untagged/Not Out at the end of the first Inning's turn, the team has the option to change the order of the remaining two Batches in the second Inning.

d) Changing the Batch order in the second Inning is not permitted if more than one Defender of the second Batch remains Untagged/Not Out.

e) These provisions also apply to a third/extra Inning in Knock-Out matches ending in a tie, but not to a Minimum Chase.

f) If more than one Batch remains Untagged/Not Out, the team may change the order of those Batches in the second Inning.

g) Defenders who remain Untagged/Not Out in the First Inning cannot be substituted in the Second Inning during their Defence turn, except in case of Injury or Red Card. They may, however, be substituted during their Attacking turn.

8. If the attacking team successfully touches out all 09 Defenders of the 03 Batches in the First Inning, the Defending Team may change the order of Batches in the Second Inning.

9. If a Defender enters the Playfield out of turn (wrong Batch), he must be called back immediately, and 02 points are awarded to the Attacking Team as Late Entry, without forfeiting his right to enter in his original Batch. If the Attacking team chases such a Defender for more than 01 minute before this is noticed, 02 points are awarded as Touched Out instead, and Rule 12 (below) applies.

10. If a Defender who entered in the wrong Batch is tagged out by the Attacking team, and this comes to the Referee's notice later, then either:

a) The Attacking Team is awarded 02 additional points as a penalty, if the Batch fixed for that Defender does not get a chance to defend during the rest of play; or

b) If the turn of his original Batch comes up later, he is not allowed to defend in that Batch (once only), and the Attacking team receives 02 points as Late Entry instead.

11. A Defender declared OUT must not obstruct any Attacker and shall move out of the Playfield immediately through the nearest Lobby.

12. An Attacker who puts out the last Defender of a Batch cannot chase Defenders of a new Batch without giving a KHO; if he does so and tags a Defender, that Defender shall not be declared out.

13. After giving one KHO, if any Defender(s) enter the Playfield, the Attacker may chase them; a second KHO is not obligatory for Defenders who have already entered.

14. After the first Defender of a Batch is declared out, the next Batch's Defenders shall enter the Entry Zone. Each side enters Defenders only through their Entry Zone. Once a Batch has entered the Entry Zone (noted by the Asst. Scorer), it cannot be changed or replaced by another Batch.

15. If all 3 Defenders of a Batch are given out as Late Entry, the Referee may declare the Batch out and allow the next Batch 15 seconds to enter (together or one by one). If the team intentionally delays sending Defenders, the Referee waits up to 60 seconds before closing the turn and reporting the matter to the Convenor, Referee Board, KKFI.

16. The Captain of the Attacking team may end the turn early after scoring 18 points in the first Inning by raising his arm and requesting the Referee; there is no such restriction in the subsequent Inning.

17. The Captain or Coach of a team trailing by 18 points or more after the first Inning may request the Referee to end the match; the Referee may allow this and declare the opposing team the winner (recorded as conceded by an Inning).

Result, Extra Inning, and Minimum Chase

1. In League/Knock-Out matches, the team scoring more points at the end of the match is declared the winner.

2. In Knock-Out matches, if the scores are level after the second Inning, one Extra Inning (one Attack and one Defence turn per side) is played. If still level, an additional Inning is played on a Minimum Chase basis.

Minimum Chase — Rules

a) The Referee starts the turn of the additional Inning. As soon as the first point is scored, the turn is closed and the stopwatch stopped. The side taking less time to score its first point is declared the winner.

The Referee stops the match in the second turn if the time taken exceeds the opponent's recorded time by more than 30 seconds.

b) The Defending team may send any 03 Defenders.

c) No additional Dream Run point is given to the Defending team.

d) If required, this process continues until a winner is decided; the time taken to secure the first point is recorded in the Score Sheet.

3. No team shall leave the Attacker Blocks or Ground without the Referee's permission; violations are reported to the Convenor, Referee Board, KKFI.

4. If a team fails to report for its match, the opponent is declared the winner, and the matter is reported to the Jury of Appeal/Organising Committee.

5. The Referee closes the turn after the winning point is scored (unless requested earlier by the Attacking captain), calculating available Dream Run points for the Defending Team beforehand.

6. On natural surfaces, the Playfield must be marked or watered twice — before the match and between Innings — at the Referee's discretion.

7. If a Defender goes Out of Field unknowingly due to contradictory decisions of two Umpires, the Referee may call him back if the final decision is Not Out.

8. If an Attacker suddenly switches from a Defender being chased for some time to tag another Defender of the same Batch, this is considered a Sudden Attack, and the Personal Time of the newly declared-out Defender is recorded as 0.00 minutes.

9. If an Attacker tags a Defender without violating any rule just before the Time Keeper's final whistle, the Defender is declared OUT (time recorded as 06.59/08.59), regardless of the Attacker's follow-through. If the touch and the whistle occur simultaneously, the Defender is not declared out. The Referee's decision is final.

Follow On

Optional: If, after the first Inning, the Attacking side's score exceeds the other side's by 12 to 16 points, it may ask the trailing side to follow on as Attacker, without forfeiting its own subsequent turn as Attacker.

Compulsory/Mandatory: If the difference after the first Inning is 18 points or more, follow on is mandatory for the trailing side. A match won via follow on is recorded as "won by an Innings."

Substitution

- a) Any number of substitutions is allowed to the Attacking Team during its Attack.
 - b) For the Defending team, substitution is allowed only before their Defence turn begins.
 - c) In case of a certified injury, the Referee may allow substitution during play/between Innings/Turns; the incoming player takes the same Batch position as the outgoing player.
 - d) A Red Card to a Defender permits substitution during their Defence; the incoming player takes the same Batch position.
 - e) Untagged/Not Out Defenders from the First Inning cannot be substituted in the Second Inning's Defence turn, except for Injury or Red Card, but may be substituted during their Attacking turn.
 - f) A Blue Card to an Attacker/Sitting Attacker requires immediate replacement by a Substitute Player; non-return after suspension converts it to a Regular Substitution.
 - g) A Red Card to an Attacker/Sitting Attacker requires immediate replacement by a Substitute Player.
 - h) Both teams substitute players only from their Substitution Zone.
 - i) Once the outgoing Sitting Attacker's number is announced, he must leave the Playfield immediately upon receiving a KHO, and the Substitute Player takes his place.
 - j) An outgoing Attacker who receives a KHO cannot chase any Defender; if he continues and tags a Defender, that Defender is not declared out.
 - k) An incoming Attacker cannot pursue Defenders directly; he must first give a KHO, failing which any Defender tagged is not declared out.
- > If a match is interrupted by natural causes, it resumes later with the same players/officials if played in the same session; scores of completed turns are retained, and play resumes from the incomplete turn. If not resumed in the same session, the match is replayed entirely (players/officials need not be the same). Matches interrupted by other than natural causes are decided by the Jury of Appeal/Organising Committee.
- > Teams shall leave the Playfield only after the Referee declares the result.

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-> If an entire session is washed out and cannot be conducted within the available time, the match(es) may be played on a Minimum Chase basis, with the toss as the final tie-breaker.

-> If a Final Match cannot be completed or conducted due to unavoidable circumstances, it is played on a Minimum Chase basis, with the toss as the final tie-breaker.

> Both Semi-Final losing teams are considered joint **THIRD PLACE WINNERS**.

Penalties

a) Minor offence (e.g., argument with opponents, spectators, or officials, shouting, etc.): a verbal warning is given; repetition results in a warning via Blue Card/Yellow Card.

b) Serious offence: the Referee may disqualify the concerned player/manager/coach for the rest of the match by showing a Red Card.

c) A Yellow Card shown twice in a match results in a ban from the rest of that match and the next match of the tournament. A Yellow Card shown in two different matches of the same tournament results in a ban from the next match.

d) A Red Card shown in a match results in a ban from the rest of that match and the next match of the tournament.

IMPORTANT NOTE:

RULES & SCHEDULE ARE SUBJECT TO CHANGE IN THE SPIRIT OF THE GAME & FESTIVAL AND THE FINAL DECISION IN ALL MATTERS RESTS WITH THE SPARDHA TEAM.